

The Legacy Garden at Headley Farm

Strategic Vision and Funding Plan

Overview:

The Legacy Garden at Headley Farm is a long-term planting initiative designed to establish a world-class flower sanctuary on our property—blending beauty, function, and storytelling. This project will elevate our brand, support the local ecosystem, buffer our retreat center from noise and visual disruption, and provide cut flowers for years to come.

The garden will feature:

- Privacy and noise-reduction plantings along the Ladiga Trail and Walmart boundary
- Aesthetic landscaping for the event/retreat center experience
- High-value perennial cut flowers for the market
- A curated botanical experience for guests, clients, and the local community
- Functional hedgerows and natural boundaries between key zones: the Pharmacy site (as part of the Ladiga Trail connector), the old farmhouse, tiny homes, event center, and production zones

Named Zones of the Garden:

- *The Orchard Gate* – flowering trees and peonies near the farm entrance
- *The Quiet Hedge* – viburnum, crabapples, ninebark buffering the Trail and Walmart
- *The Bloom Border* – showy, long-stemmed market and wedding flowers
- *The Sanctuary Edge* – spirea, baptisia, and evergreens surrounding retreat paths
- *The Way of Flowers* – meditative gravel trail winding between garden rooms

Key Perennial Varieties (Zone 8b):

- Crabapples
- Dahlias
- Peonies (Fall Planting Priority)
- Astilbe
- Veronica
- Baptisia
- Ninebark
- Spirea
- Viburnum opulus "Roseum"

Recommended Additions:

- Magnolia 'Little Gem'
- Aronia (chokeberry)
- Camellia sasanqua
- Lisianthus
- Scabiosa
- Echinacea 'White Swan'
- Salvia 'Amistad'
- Clethra (Summersweet)
- Japanese Maple
- Anise Hyssop, Joe Pye Weed, Tithonia, Hellebores, Native Ferns

Phased Implementation (2025–2027): Tier 1 (2025) – Bed prep, irrigation, peonies, shrubs, crabapples

Tier 2 (Spring 2026) – Dahlias, perennials, herbs, grasses

Tier 3 (2026–2027) – Unique varieties, view framing, garden design for weddings/retreats

Funding Strategy: 5 Paths to Grow This Now

1. Grants (Short & Long-Term)

- United Way (via Kyle/Shannon) for workforce + beautification
- USDA/NRCS EQIP for windbreaks or pollinator zones
- Arts & wellness orgs for flower therapy, mental health, beauty
- Community foundations for small-scale sustainability grants

2. GoFundMe (Fastest Community Activation)

- Campaign name: “Planting a Legacy: Help Grow the Headley Garden”
- Tiers:
 - \$25: Bloom Booster – name on a stake
 - \$100: Petal Patron – bouquet
 - \$500+: Legacy Sponsor – named signage or feature
- 1-min video walkthrough to cast the vision

3. Patreon (Ongoing Support)

- Support tiers with exclusive behind-the-scenes, bouquets, flower stories
- Includes meditations, poems, reflections, etc.

4. Pre-Sales & Sponsorships

- CSA-style “Plant Now, Harvest Later” model
- Perennial Bed Sponsorship for businesses or individuals
- Early-bird event packages with photo areas & floral backdrops

5. Strategic Partnerships

- Ben Miller for media content?
- Shea Miller for civic funding?
- Jerrod @ Called Coffee for a benefit night?

- Nursery donations or labor support from community allies?
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Ecological Impact Snapshot:

- ~150+ perennial plants introduced by 2027
 - 400+ linear feet of flowering privacy hedge
 - 8+ species of pollinator-attracting natives
 - Carbon sequestered through 25+ new shrubs and trees
 - Increased biodiversity, soil stability, and natural stormwater absorption
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Legacy Planting Day (Proposed Event):

An annual spring ritual in which community members are invited to sponsor and help plant part of the garden. Includes:

- Blessing of the soil
 - Naming dedications
 - Storytelling + flower poetry
 - Picnic on the Lawn + Photo ops
 - Each sponsor receives a digital or printed certificate with the plant name and its zone
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Next Steps:

1. Name zones: Orchard Gate, Quiet Hedge, Bloom Border, Whispering Trail
 2. Create a GoFundMe draft with vision, video, and donation tiers
 3. Draft 1-pager for Shea, Kyle, Shannon, and nursery partners
 4. Begin spreading the story—first to inner circle, then allies, then public
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Vision Script (For Video or Audio Use):

"What if beauty was more than a luxury? What if it was a kind of medicine—planted in soil, rooted in legacy, offered as a gift to the weary world?"

At Headley Farm, we're building something bold and beautiful: a Legacy Garden. It's a perennial sanctuary nestled along the Ladiga Trail, designed to bloom for

generations. This garden will do more than just grow flowers. It will buffer our farm from the noise of nearby roads and Walmart. It will provide privacy and quiet for our retreat guests. It will offer stunning seasonal cut flowers for weddings, markets, and community events. It will also serve as a living boundary—marking and softening the edges between our Farmacy healing garden, our historic home, the tiny homes, and our event spaces.

And most of all, it will stand as a testament to beauty, care, and long-term vision.

We're asking for your help to plant this story. Whether it's a stake with your name on it, a future bouquet, or sponsoring a whole garden bed—your support roots this dream in real soil. Join us in growing something that lasts."

Closing Thought:

"The best time to plant a tree was 20 years ago. The second best time is now."

You're not just planting flowers. You're planting belonging, sanctuary, and story. Let's root this legacy—today.